



Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform

Advocacy Points for EHRP Mid- Term Review

10 AUGUST 2018

BBC MEDIA ACTION

Overview



- World Bank stakeholder consultations on 'Lessons Learning and Way Forward for the Housing Reconstruction Programme' during last week of July at national level and ongoing at district level
- Objective is to *"understand the concerns and issues of the relevant stakeholders and their views on how to improve and expedite the reconstruction activities. These consultations will assist in preparing for the upcoming Mid Term Review (MTR) of Nepal Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Project (EHRP). The MTR provides stakeholders with the opportunity to review progress, draw learning and, if required, make necessary adjustments in implementation arrangements"*.

Tranche Disbursement Deadlines



- Biggest block to successful housing reconstruction
- HRRP advocates for extension of at least next 2 build seasons in rural areas and next 4 in urban
- If not extended / removed, hard to see how any other actions could have positive impact

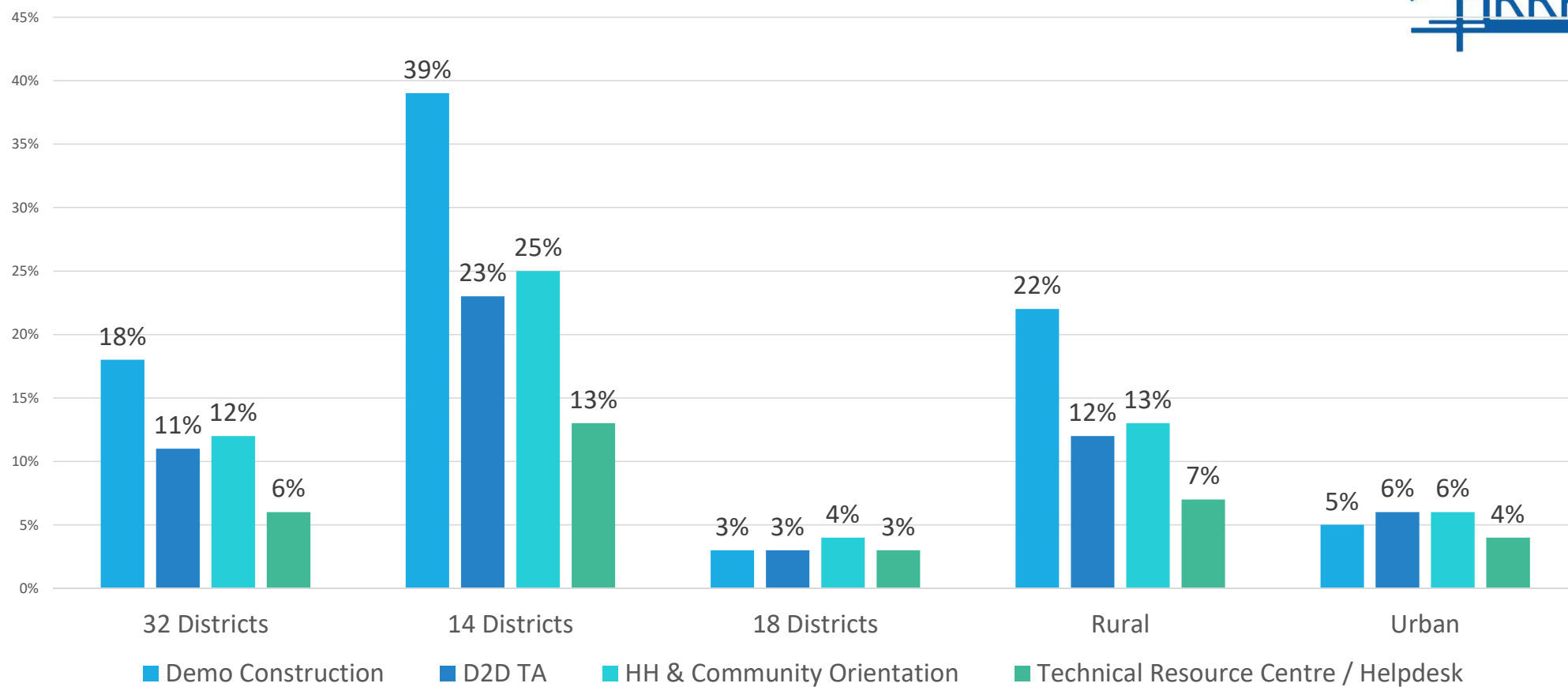


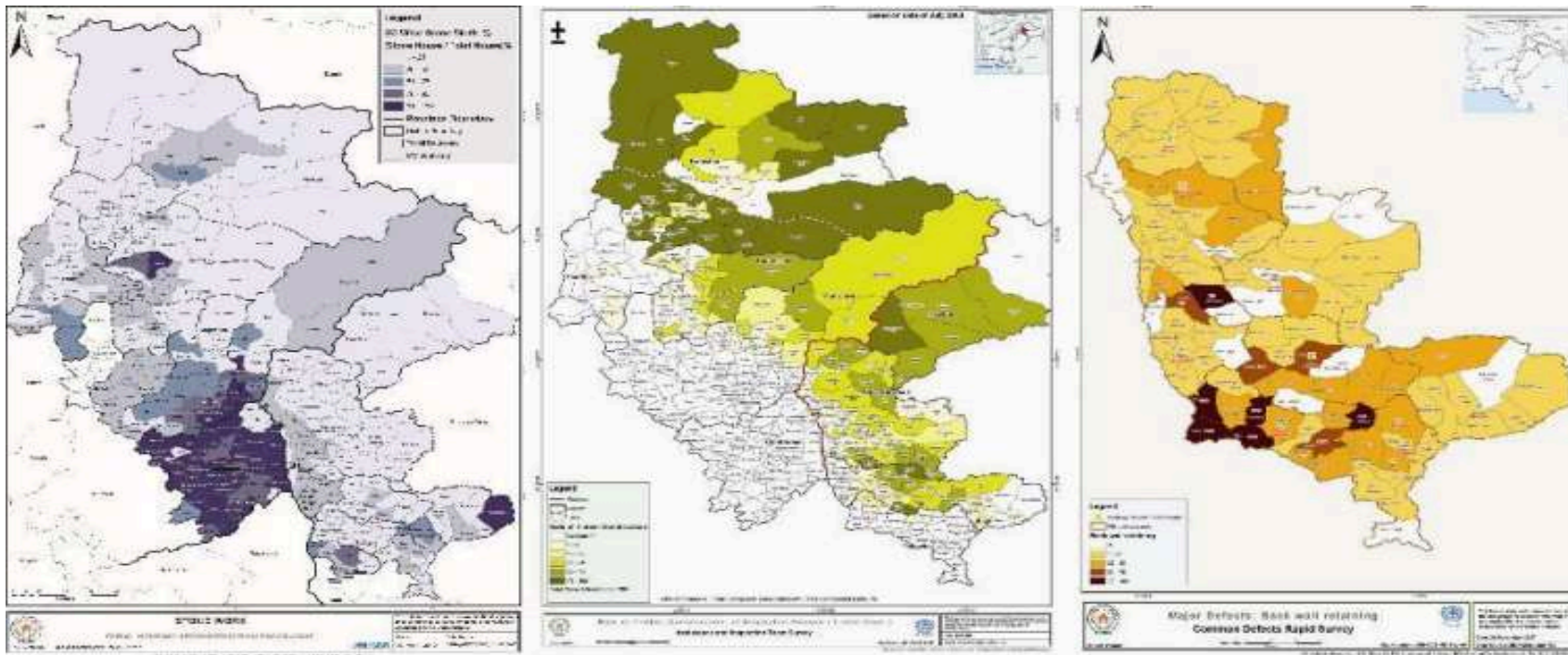


Socio-technical assistance

- Estimate that 75 million USD is required for socio-technical assistance to cover gaps and support households to completion of earthquake resilient houses across all 32 earthquake affected districts.
- This is just 7% of the amount of money yet to be disbursed through the GoN's housing reconstruction grant.

Coverage of key TA activities by % of wards (based on HRRP 4W data)





Building Typology : targeting tech information , demo/model buildings

Rate: Progress, targeting training, inspection capacity, market monitoring.

Quality: Prevalence of defects, understanding, targeting training, remedial measures,

Vulnerable HHs



- Need specific, additional support – key step is getting TA out at scale
- Consider those not part of the formal reconstruction programme.
- Where households may take longer to reconstruct, seasonal support and / or support for temporary shelter improvement should be provided

Supply Chain



- National level efforts, e.g. cut all tax on cement and steel for 1 year
- Work with construction material vendors and producers
- Support collective purchasing efforts

Address Confusion, Misinformation, and Rumours



- Standardised information to be widely distributed through a mass communications campaign, e.g. to address concept that have to follow 17 designs
- Increase engagement with national and local level media
 - Important role to play in reconstruction
 - Lots of work happening, but not very coordinated
 - How is information checked before dissemination?
 - Media engagement sessions at national and local level

Potential Debt Crisis?

- 807,486 HHs eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant.
- If 50% of these households take a loan of 3,250 USD that will be a total of more than 1.3 billion USD in debt. At an average interest rate of 23% per annum, the annual interest payment would be more than 300 million USD.
- At a HH level, if a family is paying interest of 23% per annum, they will pay almost 750 USD in interest annually on a 3,250 USD loan. If the same loan had a 2% interest rate per annum, they will pay 65 USD in interest annually.
- Over the course of a 5 year loan period (likely a conservative estimate) the difference in the amount paid in interest is 3,425 USD (3,750 USD for 23% loan and 325 USD for 2% loan).

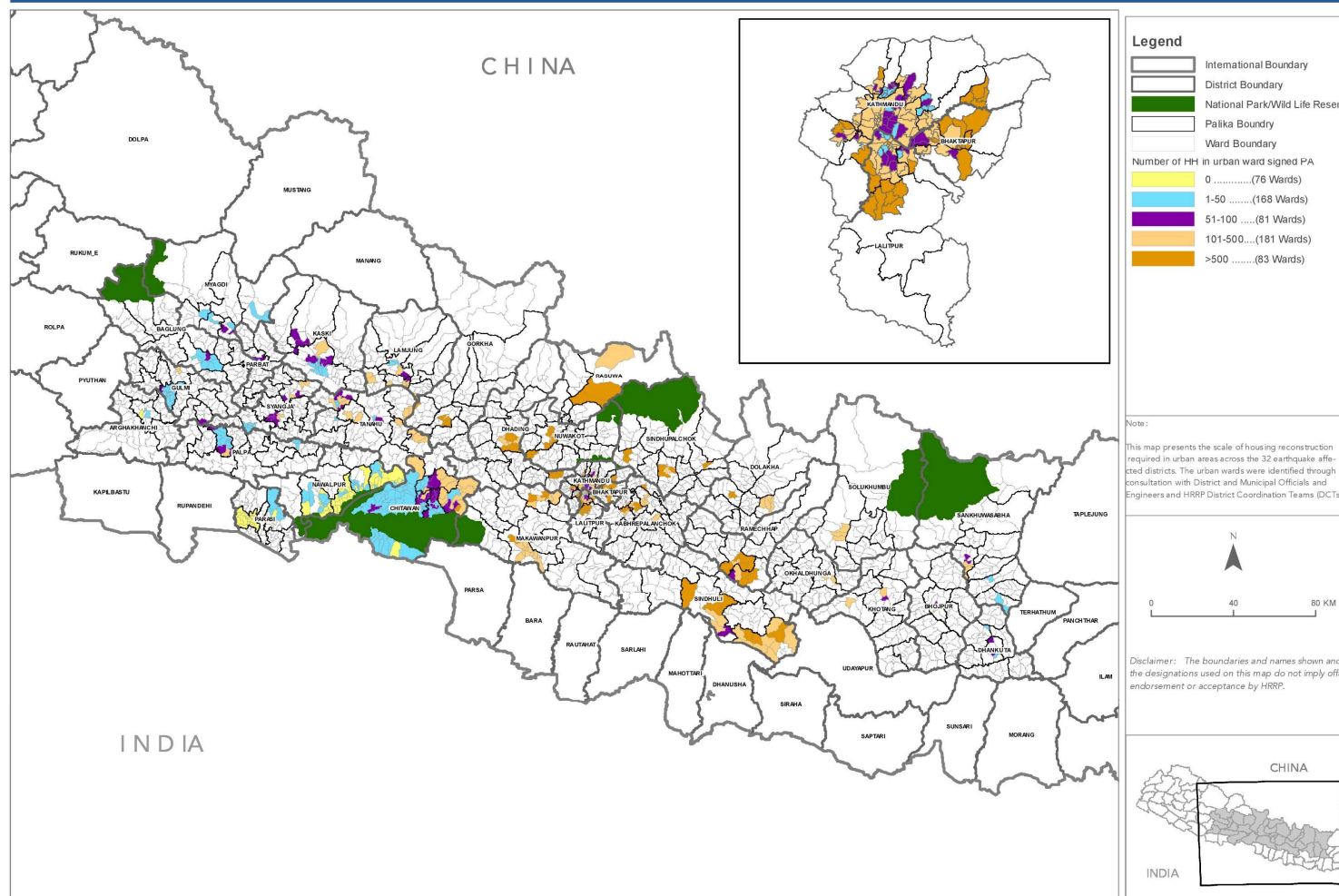
Urban Housing Reconstruction



- Urban reconstruction is complex – cannot expect to follow same timeframe or same policies as for rural reconstruction.
- Sector globally is still trying to work out how to address urban recovery – huge potential for Nepal to contribute
- What are the policies / policy changes needed for urban? E.g. in Gujarat reconstruction grant in urban areas was almost double the grant for rural areas
- Different requirements for traditional / heritage settlements, high-rise buildings
- Technical assistance in urban areas requires different approach
- Role of building permit process, municipalities – build on previous work in this area

Urban Wards in Earthquake Affected Districts

HRRP



18 Districts



- Huge gaps in coverage of socio-technical assistance
- Government technical staffs have not been trained or oriented on process, system and technical guidelines and manuals
- District Support Engineers have not been deployed in most of the districts
- Many non-compliances
- Diverse housing construction typologies and new construction trends e.g. hollow concrete blocks, steel frame etc.
- Misinformation and confusion are present at all levels – field, local, and district
- Deadlines are causing stress and concern for people



Increase support for NRA field staff



- HRRP Survey with NRA, Building DLPIU Technical Staff:
 - 489 responses; at least 25 from each of the 14 most affected districts as well as responses from Gulmi, Tanahun, Lamjung, Myagdi, Baglung, Bhojpur, Khotang, Arghakhanchi, and Nawalpur
 - 64% engineers, 21% sub-engineers, and 15% assistant sub-engineers.
 - 1% recruited in 2015, 41% in 2016, 34% in 2017, and 24% in 2018.
 - 51% did not receive any training before being deployed and 24% have not received training after deployment.
 - Walking is the primary mode of transport for 84% of respondents.
 - Respondents reported visiting an average of 34 households per month.

Capacity Building for Municipal and Ward Officials



- High level of investment and many actors involved but issues with coverage and quality / standardisation of approach
- Orientation to municipal officials on the reconstruction policy, procedures, and guidelines – mix of actors, generally just one session (not continuous), poor coverage in 18 districts
- Need continuous capacity building support, under a common approach, if their impact on the reconstruction efforts is to be maximised

Design Guidelines / Manuals



- Not sufficient to just prepare guidelines / manuals, need to disseminate and make sure that field staff can use them
 - Printing – most field staff don't have copies of guidelines and manuals
 - Training – most field staff have not received training
- Ongoing work to prepare manuals / design guidelines for other construction materials and technologies
 - Hollow concrete blocks
 - CSEB
 - Non-compliances

Invest in Coordination

- Coordination only works if it is embraced at all levels and leads to an open, collaborative approach amongst all reconstruction actors
- Includes:
 - Inter-ministerial coordination,
 - Coordination between donors,
 - Coordination between donors and NRA, coordination between POs,
 - Coordination between POs and NRA,
 - Coordination between POs, etc.
- Flow from ward to municipal to provincial to central level
- Collaboration > Coordination – next step?

Institutionalise Recovery Experience



- Document and institutionalise recovery experience periodically and systematically now – not just at the end of the reconstruction.
- Contribute to NDMA setup
- Contribute to annual preparedness planning
- Contribute to future responses – roster of experienced personnel?
- Strengthen engagement with DRR sector / actors